
IDOL
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DIGITAL SPARKS
Break Boundaries. Build Possibilities
MERALCO Power Academy
MERALCO
November 12-13, 2026
Meralco Multi-purpose Hall

OPENING REMARKS





Ms. Kathleen Kristy Dorico

Director, Advocacy and Communications
Meralco Power Academy

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THE ENEMY CALLED AVERAGE.



01

VISION

Seeing beyond the majority



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VISION: Seeing beyond the majority



01 You cannot seize what you cannot see

02 You can only go as far as you can see

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02

DETERMINATION

Deciding to hang tough

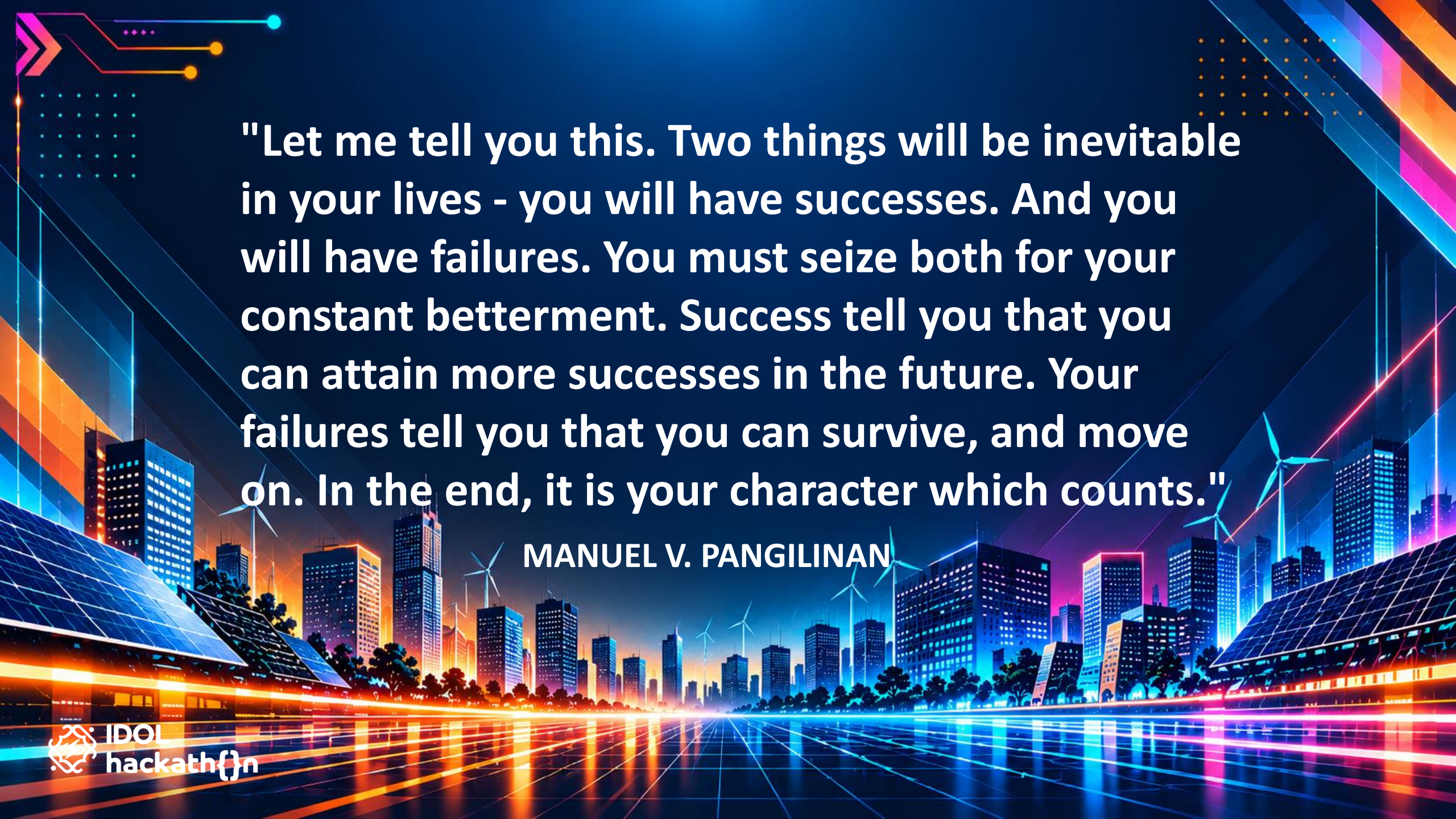


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DETERMINATION IS MERELY ABOUT BEING SUCCESSFUL — IT IS ABOUT BECOMING.

DETERMINATION SHAPES OUR CHARATERS.




"Let me tell you this. Two things will be inevitable in your lives - you will have successes. And you will have failures. You must seize both for your constant betterment. Success tell you that you can attain more successes in the future. Your failures tell you that you can survive, and move on. In the end, it is your character which counts."
MANUEL V. PANGILINAN
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IT’S WHAT YOU DO — NOT WHEN YOU DO IT

Ted Williams, at age 42, slammed a home run in his last official time at bat.
Mickey Matle, age 20, hit 23 home rums his first full year in the major leagues.
Golda Meir was 71 when she became Prime Minister of Israel.
William Pitt II was 24 when he became Prime Minister of Great Britain.
George Bernard Shaw was 94 when one of his plays was first produced.
Mozart was just seven when his first composition was published.
No, how about this? Benjamin Franklin was a newspaper columnist at 16 and a framer of the United State Constitution when he was 81.

You’re never too young or too old if you’ve got talent. Let’s recognize that age has little to do with ability.




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MECHANICS AND GUIDELINES

HACKATHON PROPER

Date: November 12 - 13, 2026 (Round-The-Clock)

- This is a face-to-face event; all team members must be physically present at the venue with complete registration (this includes Application Form, Student Verification document/s and signed TERMS and Privacy Notice and Consent during the application process).
- Registration begins at 7:30 AM. Please arrive no later than 8:15 AM.
- Participants will receive the official hackathon challenge statements and choose one challenge to address during the hackathon.
- Participants may not join more than one team or submit more than one entry per team.

MECHANICS AND GUIDELINES

- All source code must be written between November 12, 9:00 AM to November 13, 9:00 AM.
- Participants are allowed to install software, plan their projects, and gather data sets in advance, but coding and/or assembly of hardware components must only occur during the Hackathon period.
- Teams can use publicly available libraries, packages, design assets, and APIs. Any additional assets used during the event must be approved by the Organizers.
- Submissions must include all relevant files (e.g. GitHub repository link) and be completed before November 13, 9:30AM. Late submissions will not be accepted.
- Coaches will be available for mentorship and support.
- Participants may leave the venue, but at least one representative must remain present at the venue throughout the hacking period.
- All devices related to the Hackathon Project must be left at the premises if the participants leave the venue.

MECHANICS AND GUIDELINES

GROUNDS FOR DISQUALIFICATION

- Plagiarism
- Violation of event policies, terms, and conditions
- Breach of data ethics standards, data privacy, or security protocols

PRESENTATION GUIDELINES

- Teams will present their projects in a dedicated area.
- Each team will have up to 15 minutes to present; 10 minutes for actual presentation, and 5 minutes for judges' to ask their questions and for the team or participants to answer them (Q&A).
- The project pitch should be focused on a working demonstration of the project.

OFFICIAL HACKATHON CHALLENGES

1 Clean Energy Adoption and Rewards

How might we help customers compare solar options, and to recognize and reward sustainable energy choices, using clear, comparable and verifiable information?

2 Know Your Bill, Manage Your Usage

How might we help customers understand what makes up their electricity bill, use their own consumption data to manage their usage.

3 Grid Intelligence from Connected Devices

How might we combine data from smart meters, IoT sensors, field devices and other data-gathering tools with publicly available online information to understand how the distribution network is behaving? This includes recognizing changing demand such as electric vehicle charging, spotting unusual patterns that may point to equipment issues or safety hazards, and confirming and locating possible power issues.

4 Smarter Field Observation

How might we use field assets, such as utility vehicles, dashcams, smartphones and low-cost environmental sensors, to safely captures useful environmental and infrastructure data?

CRITERIA FOR JUDGING

Innovation

30%

How original and creative is the solution? Does it introduce fresh ideas or concepts that differentiate it from existing solutions? Does it approach the problem in an unconventional way that offers a unique perspective or methodology? The degree of innovation should reflect novelty, originality, and inventive thinking.

Impact

20%

How meaningful is the solution's potential to create positive change? Does it address a significant real-world problem or societal need? Is there a clear demonstration of how it could benefit individuals, communities, or industries on a local or global scale? Impact should be assessed based on its practical value and potential reach.

Functionality

25%

How well does the solution work in practice? Is it fully operational and free from critical errors or bugs? Does it meet the objectives and perform the required tasks efficiently? The evaluation focuses on the solution’s reliability, stability, and overall user experience.

Technical Challenge

15%

How sophisticated was the solution to build? Does the implementation demonstrate advanced technical skills, creativity in applying technology, or problem-solving? Was the solution developed using a high degree of technical expertise, and does it efficiently address difficult challenges with innovative techniques or algorithms?

Presentation

10%

How effectively was the solution communicated to the audience? Was the pitch structured clearly, concise, and engaging? Did the presentation successfully highlight the key features, benefits, and impact of the solution? The assessment should consider the clarity of delivery, visual aids, storytelling, and ability to answer questions convincingly.

YOUR IDOL HACKATHON JUDGES



Jose “Jojo” Reyes
Head, Networks Technology Management



Joy P. Mendoza
Head, Customer Care Group



Francis Dino S. Antonio
Head, Regulatory Legal Case Management

YOUR IDOL HACKATHON MENTORS



John Robert Gregorio
Enterprise Solutions Architect



John Louis De Leon
Project Security Testing Specialist



Andy Bagadiong
Innovation Labs Associate



JC Gofredo
Solutions Engineering



Jaspher Atienza
Associate Customer Touchpoint Solutions



Mc Kinley Tolentino
Associate Customer Touchpoint Solutions

AWARDING CEREMONIES

Awarding will commence on November 24, 2026, during the Innovation Awards Culminating event.
Winning teams will receive an invitation to the awarding ceremonies.

IMPORTANT REMINDERS

Entry Points:

- By car: Use Gate 2
- On foot: Enter through the Lopez Lobby

Identification:

- Please bring your School ID for verification.

We recommend that the participants bring the following:

- Tumbler
- Medicines/supplements
- Extra clothes

Sustainability Policy:

- Single-Use Plastics (SUPs) are strictly prohibited. This sustainability guideline covers all offices and facilities of Meralco.


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